

SD WORX TRACK · CHALLENGE 03

From CAO to payroll check

Hackathon challenge brief · 4 hours · Pitch in English

Context

Every Belgian employer falls under a joint committee (paritair comité / commission paritaire). Its collective agreements (CAO / CCT) set minimum wage scales, seniority steps, bonuses, premiums, meal vouchers and, since flexi-jobs opened to all sectors on 1 July 2026, sometimes a sector opt-out. Payroll has to be PC-aware: the same gross pay can be right in one sector and wrong in another.

Today a payroll consultant reads each new agreement, often in Dutch or French, and translates it into payroll parameters by hand. It is careful work, but it is manual, and when something is missed the error tends to surface months later: an employee notices, a union delegate calls, or an inspection finds it. By then, correcting it means back pay and a difficult conversation with the client.

In June 2026 we launched a multi-agent payroll model in which our consultants supervise a team of AI agents and validate what they produce. We have seen promising internal prototypes of agents that turn legal text into rules. Now we want to see how far you can take the idea.

The challenge

How might we help a payroll consultant turn a new collective agreement into payroll rules they trust, and then catch every payroll line that breaks them, before the payslips go out?

We imagine an agent that reads the agreement, proposes structured rules, lets the consultant approve them, and then checks a client's payroll run and explains what it finds. How you shape that is up to you.

Who you're building for

A payroll consultant in our Belgian SME team. They handle a portfolio of client companies across several joint committees, read Dutch and French, and are accountable for every payslip. They do not want a black box: they need to see where a rule comes from and decide whether it is right.

What we give you

All data is synthetic, for a fictional joint committee (**PC 399.07**) and a fictional client.

- `materials/docs/cao_01_loonschalen_nl.md`: wage scales and seniority steps (Dutch)
- `materials/docs/cct_02_prime_cheques_repas_fr.md`: end-of-year bonus and meal vouchers (French)
- `materials/docs/cao_03_nachtarbeid_flexi_nl-fr.md`: night-work premium and flexi-jobs (bilingual)
- `materials/payroll_run_2026-10.csv`: the client's October 2026 payroll run, 40 employees
- `materials/README.md`: what each file and column means

What success looks like for us

- Every rule points back to the exact article and paragraph it came from.
- The consultant stays in control: nothing is applied until a human has approved it.
- Every finding on the payroll run is explained in plain language a consultant could forward to the client.
- Agreements change all the time. Your solution should cope with that.

- A credible view of the value: time saved, errors caught earlier, or risk avoided.

Constraints

- Treat PC 399.07 as fictional. Do not present its figures as real Belgian law.
- Employee data is personal data. Show us how you handle it responsibly.
- The consultant decides, the agent assists.

Practical

- Working language and pitch: English. The documents are in Dutch and French.
- Pitch: 3 minutes, live demo preferred, followed by questions from the jury.
- Any stack. A working prototype beats slides. Mentors are available during the build.

Fictional practice material for team IF-ELSE drills. SD Worx facts used: joint committees and CAOs, flexi-jobs opening on 1 July 2026, the June 2026 multi-agent payroll model.